

3 BUSINESS

Discussion point

Discuss with a partner.

- 1 Which points in the infographic do you think are most useful for people in business?
- 2 What other things do you think help people become successful in business?
- 3 How could these tips help people in other areas of their life? For example, studying.

To succeed in business ...

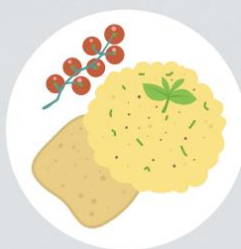


Plan in **minutes**, not **hours**

Do the **hardest** tasks first



Check **e-mails** only a few times a day



Eat a **healthy breakfast** and don't miss meals, sleep or breaks



VIDEO



YOUNG ENTREPRENEURS

Before you watch

Work with a partner. What do most people want to do after they finish college?

- 1 Start their own company
- 2 Work for a large company
- 3 Work for a small private company

UNIT AIMS

READING 1 Identifying supporting details
 READING 2 Signposting
 STUDY SKILL What are recruiters looking for?

VOCABULARY Business verbs
 GRAMMAR Modals of obligation and necessity
 WRITING Writing an introduction



Modern business meeting.

While you watch

Read the statements and then watch the video.
 Choose the correct option to complete the sentences.

- 1 A lot of China's young people want **an office job / to be entrepreneurs**.
- 2 Song left his job because he **was bored / wanted more money**.
- 3 Cui Ernan thinks starting a business and making money **is / isn't** something everyone can do.
- 4 Jack Ma and Ma Huateng were very **lucky / experienced**.

After you watch

Answer the questions with a partner.

- 1 Do lots of students you know in your country try to start their own companies?
No, in my country ...
Yes, they do. Many people ...
- 2 Is it difficult to find a job after college?
Yes, it is, because ...
No, it isn't, because ...
- 3 What type of businesses do people try to start?
Lots of people want to open ...

1 READING

How much is it worth?

A Vocabulary preview

1 Complete the sentences with the words in the box.

brand customer service excellence logo quality trust value

- 1 Do you _____ sales staff or do you think they are just trying to make money?
- 2 How important is good _____ to you? Would you use a company if staff were rude to you?
- 3 What _____ of clothing is the most popular in your country?
- 4 _____ in customer service and perfect support is the most important thing for a business. To what extent do you agree with this?
- 5 What do you think adds _____ to businesses? What makes a company successful?
- 6 A company _____ is something people should remember. Which symbols do you know the best?
- 7 What is more important for you, good- _____ products or cheap products?

2 Discuss the questions in Exercise 1 with a partner.

B Before you read

Think about your favorite clothing brands and technology products. Tell your partner about them and why you like them.

C Global reading

1 Match these questions with paragraphs 2–4.

- 1 What do brands say about people?
- 2 How important is customer service?
- 3 How important are quality products?

2 Using the questions from Exercise 1, which paragraph would you expect to see these words in?

apologize image quality reputation rude standard

3 Scan the text and check your predictions.

Preparing to read

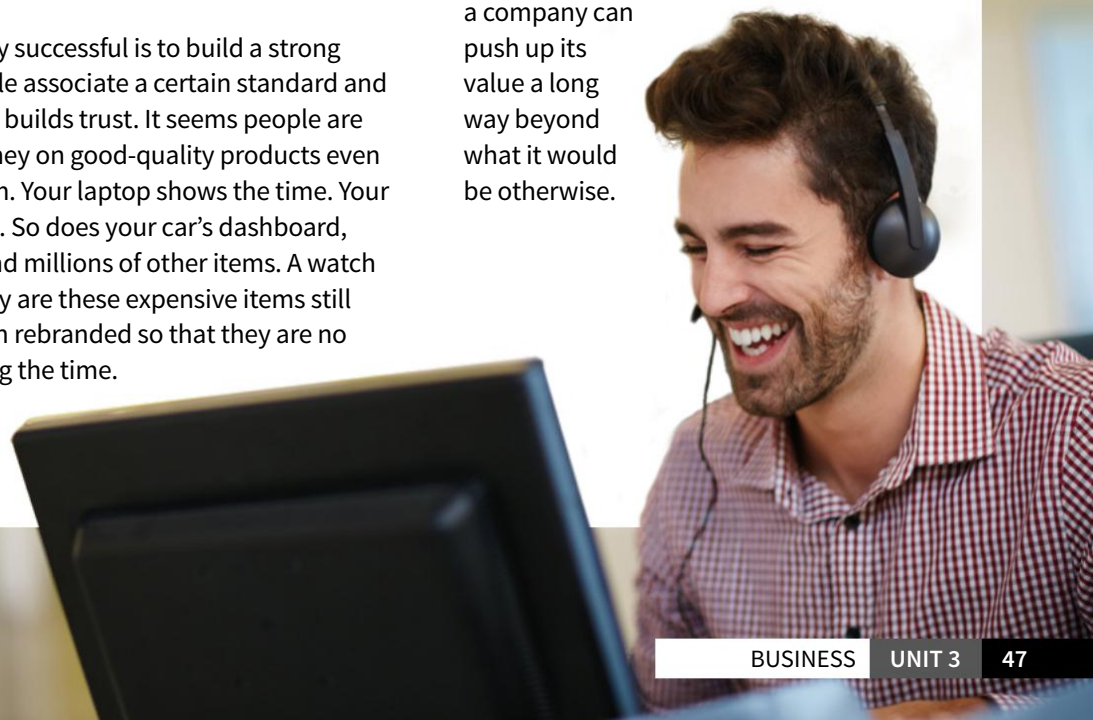
Identifying main ideas

How much is it worth?

- 1 When people think of a valuable company they tend to think of how much the company is worth in terms of money. Every year, companies report how much money they have made and directors' salaries and bonuses also depend on the money brought in. While this may be what the company owners value, to build a successful business, you need to think about the things customers value. Customer service, well-known brands, and quality products are all ways in which we can judge the value of a company.
- 2 Successful businesses know that they must provide good customer service as they will be judged by it. For instance, rude customer service, unlike a faulty product, cannot be returned. Of course, you can apologize, but the damage has already been done and sales could decline as a result. Excellence in customer service is very important because the cost of attracting a new customer is much higher than the cost of keeping an existing one. Which means increasing the number of customers you keep can make your company more profitable. If a company has a unique product, this is perhaps less of an issue, but when two or more companies are selling basically the same product, the success of the company depends on how well its customers are treated. This means that companies need to communicate clearly, fix problems quickly, personalize the sales experience, and employ the right people.
- 3 One way to make a company successful is to build a strong brand. This is because people associate a certain standard and quality with brands and this builds trust. It seems people are willing to spend a lot of money on good-quality products even when they do not need them. Your laptop shows the time. Your cell phone displays the time. So does your car's dashboard, the screen in the subway, and millions of other items. A watch is no longer essential, so why are these expensive items still popular? Watches have been rebranded so that they are no longer simply tools for telling the time. They show what kind of a person the wearer is, represent tradition,

and use technology. Much like cars, they are used by people to show their status.

- 4 Brands are also important because they say something about who we are. When people think of a brand, the values associated with it come to people's minds. Whether a brand is seen as family-friendly, popular, or user-friendly is important because we like to buy brands that represent how we like to present ourselves to others. If people see themselves as creative then they are more likely to buy creative products that match their self-image. One way companies build these values and their reputation is through their logo and by linking it to particular celebrities. If a famous person is known for being a good family person, then a company may use them to help link this characteristic to their products.
- 5 Companies, when well-managed, can create value by focusing on quality products and building their brand. With clever marketing and by maintaining good customer service a company can push up its value a long way beyond what it would be otherwise.



1 READING

Identifying supporting details

D Close reading

Supporting details are used to give the reader a clearer understanding of the topic. You can identify these using a number of key phrases.

Examples:

such as, for instance, one example is

Reasons:

because, due to, in order to

Explanations:

in other words, which means

1 Scan the text to complete the supporting details.

- 1 You can return a broken product, but you cannot return _____.
- 2 It is more expensive to attract _____ than to keep old ones.
- 3 A lot of companies sell the same _____.
- 4 People are willing to spend a lot of money on _____ products.
- 5 People do not need _____, but they are still popular.
- 6 People like to buy brands that represent _____.

2 Look at the main ideas (1–3) below. Match the details 1–6 in Exercise 1 with the main ideas they support.

- 1 People link logos and brands to their identities. ____
- 2 Good customer service is very important. ____
- 3 People value high-quality products. ____

E Critical thinking

1 Which of the ideas in the text do you think adds most value to a company? Customer service, a well-known brand, or quality products? Why do you think this?

I think ... adds most value because ...

2 What other things not mentioned in the text do you think add value to a company? Discuss your ideas with a partner. Think about:

company hours

happy and reliable employees

quick service

other ...